# Inbox & Calendar Management

A client returns from a four-day trip to 15 unread emails. One is an emergency, one is a phishing attempt, and two would double-book her week.

| CLIENT | ROLE | TOOLS | TIME ZONES |
|---|---|---|---|
| Larkspur Property Co. | Remote VA | Google Calendar | Central (client), Philippine (VA) |

**15**
emails triaged

**1**
emergency escalated by 7:00 AM

**1**
phishing email caught

**0**
calendar conflicts

## THE SCENARIO

Dana Whitfield is back from four days away. Her inbox holds 15 emails: tenant requests, vendor invoices, a city inspection, a scheduling request, spam, and a ceiling leak reported in a low-key email with a lowercase subject line.

## THE TASK

Triage all 15 emails against Dana's seven standing rules, escalate what can't wait, draft the replies, build her calendar for the week, and send her a summary of what needs her decision.

## WHAT'S INSIDE


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## WHAT IT SHOWS

- Prioritization: connected the leak in one unit with a damp floor in the unit above it, across three separate emails
- Working within limits: every action maps to one of the client's rules, and decisions outside the VA's authority go back to the client
- Security awareness: spotted a look-alike vendor domain asking for payment to new bank details
- Time-zone fluency: the client's calendar runs on Central Time and is managed from the Philippines

# Larkspur Property Co. — VA Inbox Task

Prepared by Russle Alex Teñoso · Shift: Mon, Nov 9, 2026, 7:00 AM CT (9:00 PM PHT) · Fictional portfolio sample

## 1. Task overview

Dana Whitfield returned from a 4-day trip with 15 unread emails (Thu Nov 5 – Mon Nov 9). The task: triage all 15 against her seven standing rules, draft replies, build her calendar for Nov 9–13, and write her a summary. All times are Central Time.

## 2. Key insights

**Read everything before acting.** Emails 9, 12 and 15 describe one problem from three angles. Handled in order, a VA would book a plumber for 303 and miss that 307 is the likely source.

**Rules beat speed.** Every decision maps to one of Dana's seven rules. That makes the work auditable: Dana can check why, not just what.

**Deadlines hide inside details.** The inspection confirmation is due Tuesday, but the 48-hour tenant notice quietly moves the real deadline to Monday.

**Security is part of admin work.** The phishing email copies a real invoice number. Only a one-letter domain change gives it away, which is why payment-detail changes are always verified by phone.

**Escalate early, decide within limits.** The $350 repair was within my authority, but water damage met the emergency rule, so I booked it and told Dana anyway. Authority and escalation are separate questions.

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## 3. Triage summary

Inbox triage · Monday, November 9 · 7:00 AM CT

# Dana Whitfield's inbox, sorted

15 emails received Thu, Nov 5 to Mon, Nov 9. Sorted by urgency against Dana's standing rules.

| 5 | 1 | 6 | 3 |
|---|---|---|---|
| Urgent today | Money, forward only | Schedule or acknowledge | Low priority |

### Urgent — Act before 9 AM

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| #9 | **Ceiling leak, Unit 303**<br>Carlos Vega · active drip since Sat | Water emergency (Rule 1). Text Dana at 7:00 AM. Reassure tenant. |
| #12 | **Water heater knock + damp floor, 307**<br>Olivia Scott · unit directly above 303 | Likely source of the 303 leak. Ask tenant for access during AquaFix visit. |
| #15 | **AquaFix service offer**<br>$350 diagnostic + minor repair | Book Mon 1:00 PM (under $500, Rule 2). Ask them to check 307 too; quote first. |
| #7 | **Code inspection, Willow Row**<br>Confirm by Tue 9 AM · 48-hr tenant notice | Confirm today. Send written notice to Units 301–306 today. |
| #11 | **"Updated payment details"**<br>lonestar-landscapinq.example | Phishing. Don't click, reply or pay. Flag to Dana (Rule 3). |

### Money — Forward to Dana

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| #2 | **Invoice #1047, $1,840**<br>Lone Star Landscaping · due Nov 20 | Forward to Dana. Never pay or approve (Rule 3). |

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## This week — Schedule or acknowledge

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| #3 | **Move staff meeting**<br>Marisol Reyes | Move to Tue 11:00–12:00. Dana is free (Rule 7). |
| #5 | **Insurance renewal call**<br>Mark Delaney · renews Dec 1 | Thu 10 AM clashes with inspection. Propose Fri 10:00 AM. |
| #10 | **Viewing request, 1-bed Willow Row**<br>Jordan Ellis | Wed 2 PM clashes with dentist. Book Tue 3:00 PM (Rule 5). |
| #4 | **Noise complaint, Unit 211**<br>Ivy Chen | Acknowledge. Dana follows up. |
| #8 | **Late rent request, Unit 305**<br>Fatima Noor | Acknowledge only. No promise on rent or fees (Rule 4). |
| #13 | **Lease renewal, Unit 213**<br>Rachel Stone | Acknowledge only. No promise on rent (Rule 4). |

## Low — File or ignore

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| #14 | **Dentist reminder**<br>Already on calendar | Leave for Dana to confirm. |
| #1 | **ARHA newsletter**<br>Dues renew Jan 1 | Archive. Mention dues in summary. |
| #6 | **ReviewBoost promo**<br>Fake-review service | Mark as spam. |

### Calendar conflicts caught

- Insurance Thu 10 AM overlaps the 9–12 inspection.
- Viewing Wed 2 PM overlaps the dentist.
- Inspection notice must go out Monday to meet the 48-hour rule.

## 4. Escalation: text to Dana (7:00 AM)

Hi Dana, welcome back. Urgent: Unit 303 (Willow Row) has an active ceiling leak since Sat. 307 above it reports a knocking water heater and damp floor, likely the source. I've booked AquaFix today at 1 PM ($350 diagnostic; they'll quote before bigger work). Also: a phishing email is pretending to be Lone Star Landscaping. Don't pay anything to new bank details. Full summary in your inbox.

## 5. Draft replies

### AquaFix Plumbing (#15)

Good morning, please confirm today, Monday Nov 9 at 1:00 PM for Unit 303, Willow Row. The tenant in Unit 307 directly above reports a knocking water heater and a damp floor, so please check that unit too if the tenant allows access. Please quote before any work beyond the $350 estimate. Thank you.

### Carlos Vega, Unit 303 (#9)

Hi Carlos, thank you for the bucket and for calling. AquaFix will come today at 1:00 PM. Please let us know right away if the dripping gets worse.

### Olivia Scott, Unit 307 (#12)

Hi Olivia, thank you for flagging this. It may be connected to a leak below you. AquaFix is coming today at 1:00 PM. May they check your water heater then? If water starts pooling, please tell us right away.

### Paula Navarro, Code Compliance (#7)

Ms. Navarro, confirming the Willow Row inspection on Thursday, Nov 12, 9:00 AM–12:00 PM, with access to Units 301–306. Written notice is going to tenants today. Regards, [VA] on behalf of Dana Whitfield.

### Notice to Units 301–306

Dear Resident, the City will conduct a routine inspection of your unit on Thursday, Nov 12, between 9:00 AM and 12:00 PM. Please contact the office with any questions. — Larkspur Property Co.

### Marisol Reyes (#3)

Hi Marisol, done. Tuesday's staff meeting is now 11:00 AM–12:00 PM.

### Mark Delaney, Hill Country Insurance (#5)

Good morning Mark, Dana is booked Thursday morning. Would Friday, Nov 13 at 10:00 AM work for the 30-minute call?

### Jordan Ellis (#10)

Hello Jordan, Tuesday, Nov 10 at 3:00 PM works for the Willow Row 1-bedroom. See you then!

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Ivy Chen #4, Fatima Noor #8, Rachel Stone #13

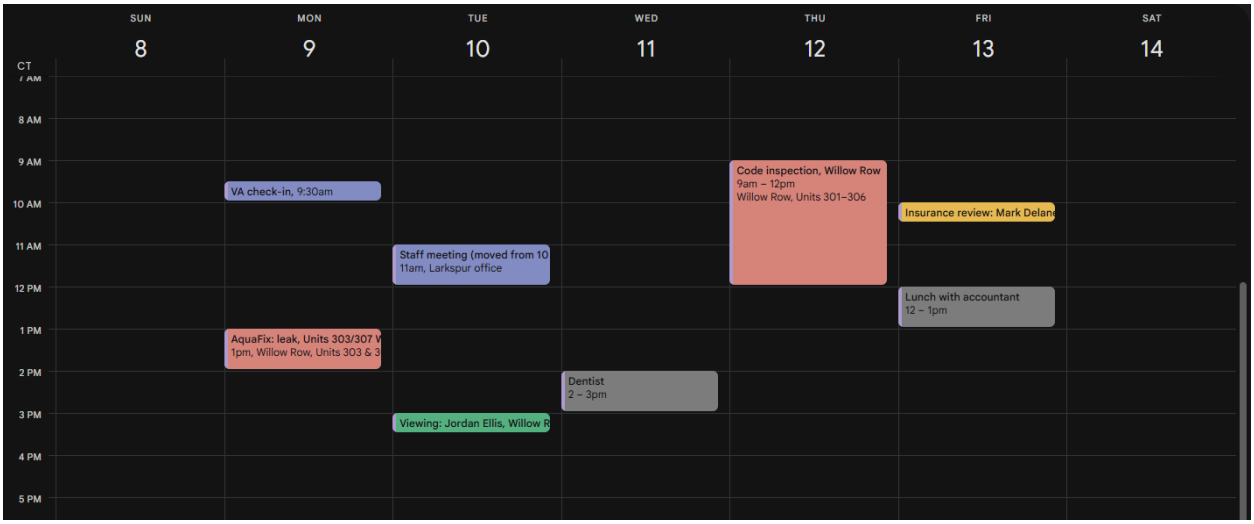
> Hi [Name], thank you for letting us know. I've passed this to Dana, and she'll follow up with you directly.

Forward to Dana: Invoice #1047 (#2)

> Hi Dana, forwarding Lone Star's October invoice ($1,840, due Nov 20) for your review. Note: a separate email (#11) from a look-alike domain asked for payment to new bank details. I did not act on it.

## 6. Calendar, Nov 9–13

| Day | Time (CT) | Event | Status |
|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | 9:30–10:00 AM | VA check-in | Existing |
| Mon | 1:00 PM | AquaFix, Units 303/307 (FYI) | New |
| Tue | 11:00 AM–12:00 PM | Staff meeting | Moved |
| Tue | 3:00–3:30 PM | Viewing, Jordan Ellis | New |
| Wed | 2:00–3:00 PM | Dentist | Existing |
| Thu | 9:00 AM–12:00 PM | Code inspection, Willow Row | Existing |
| Fri | 10:00–10:30 AM | Insurance call, Mark Delaney | Pending |
| Fri | 12:00–1:00 PM | Lunch with accountant | Existing |




*Google Calendar week view (Central Time) of the sample calendar, Nov 8–14, 2026.*

Checks: nothing before 9:00 AM; at least 15 minutes between appointments; viewing inside the Tue–Thu, 1–5 PM window.

## 7. Summary email to Dana

**Subject: Your inbox while you were away — 3 urgent items**

**Needs you now**
• Leak in 303, possibly from 307's water heater. AquaFix booked today at 1 PM ($350).
• Phishing: Email #11 is from "lonestar-landscapin**q**", not the real domain. I didn't act on it. Recommend calling Lone Star at their known number.
• Invoice #1047 ($1,840, due Nov 20) forwarded for your approval.

**Your decisions**
• Fatima (305): asks to pay rent 5 days late.
• Rachel (213): renewal, asks whether rent stays the same.
• Ivy (211): noise complaint about a neighbor.
• Dentist: reply C to confirm, if you'd like.

**Done**
• Inspection confirmed and tenant notices sent.
• Staff meeting moved to Tue 11:00.
• Viewing booked for Tue 3 PM.
• Insurance call proposed for Fri 10 AM.
• Spam and newsletter archived (ARHA dues renew Jan 1).

**Heads-up:** 303 is in Thursday's inspection, so the leak should be fixed or documented before then.

## 8. Judgment calls

• **Leak treated as an emergency.** Active water qualifies under Rule 1, so Dana is texted immediately even though the $350 repair is within my booking authority.

• **AquaFix booked despite not being vetted.** The tenant found them on a fridge magnet. I booked because water damage worsens by the hour, and flagged it for Dana.

• **Insurance call proposed, not confirmed.** Mark offered Friday; I picked a time that keeps buffers around Dana's lunch.

• **No promises to tenants.** Rent, late fees and renewal terms are Dana's call (Rule 4).

## 9. Possible efficiency improvements

• **Inbox filters:** auto-label newsletters, spam and billing senders, clearing about 3 of 15 emails before triage.

• **Emergency keyword alerts:** flag leak, water, smoke, gas, no heat, break-in for instant review. A person still decides.

• **Reply templates:** tenant acknowledgment, viewing confirmation, inspection notice.

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• **Booking link:** encode viewing hours, the 9 AM start and 15-minute buffers so conflicts can't be booked.

• **Invoice auto-forward:** route billing senders straight to Dana.

• **Approved vendor list:** vetted vendors and rates, which settles questions like AquaFix instantly.

**Kept manual:** emergency judgment, phishing checks (email #11 would pass most filters) and tenant replies, where an automated message could read as a promise.

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# Project 4 Email Pack — Larkspur Property Co. (Sample)

Oct 12, 2026 · @Russle Alex Teñoso

## Read me first

You start work Monday, November 9, 2026, at 7:00 AM Central Time (9:00 PM Philippine Time). Dana Whitfield is back from a 4-day trip and has 15 unread emails from Thursday, Nov 5 to Monday morning.

- **Your job:** triage all 15, draft replies, build her calendar for Mon Nov 9 – Fri Nov 13, and write her a summary.
- **Time zone:** all timestamps are Central Standard Time (UTC-6). US clocks fell back on Nov 1, so Austin is 14 hours behind Manila this week.
- **Read everything first.** Don't act on email 1 before you've seen email 15.
- **Fictional content:** every person, company, and domain here is invented for a portfolio sample. Domains use `.example` on purpose.

## Dana's standing instructions

Dana sent you these rules on your first day. They define what you can do alone and what needs her.

1. **Emergencies** (water, fire, gas, no heat, break-ins): text or call me right away, even if I'm on vacation.
2. **Repairs:** you can book and confirm vendor visits under $500. Anything over $500 needs my OK.
3. **Money:** never pay, approve, or change payment details on any invoice. Forward invoices to me.
4. **Tenants:** don't promise anything about rent, late fees, or lease terms. Acknowledge, and tell them I'll follow up.
5. **Viewings:** Tuesday to Thursday, 1:00–5:00 PM only.
6. **My calendar:** nothing before 9:00 AM. Keep 15 minutes between appointments.
7. **Internal meetings:** you can reschedule staff meetings if the new time is free for me.

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## Dana's existing calendar

These 5 events are already booked for Nov 9–13. Add them to your sample calendar first, then build around them.

| Day | Time (CT) | Event | Category |
|---|---|---|---|
| Mon, Nov 9 | 9:30–10:00 AM | Check-in call with VA (you) | Internal |
| Tue, Nov 10 | 10:00–11:00 AM | Staff meeting, Larkspur office | Internal |
| Wed, Nov 11 | 2:00–3:00 PM | Dentist appointment | Blocked |
| Thu, Nov 12 | 9:00 AM–12:00 PM | Code inspection, Willow Row | Vendor |
| Fri, Nov 13 | 12:00–1:00 PM | Lunch with accountant | Blocked |

## The 15 emails

All emails were sent to dana@larkspurproperty.example and are listed oldest first.

### Email 1

**From:** Austin Rental Housing Association news@arha.example **Sent:** Thu, Nov 5, 9:12 AM **Subject:** November Member Newsletter

Hi members, this month: winter-prep checklist for rental properties, updates to our December networking mixer, and a reminder that annual dues renew January 1. Read the full newsletter on our member portal.

### Email 2

**From:** Lone Star Landscaping Billing billing@lonestar-landscaping.example **Sent:** Thu, Nov 5, 11:40 AM **Subject:** Invoice #1047 — October Grounds Maintenance

Hello Dana,

Attached is Invoice #1047 for October grounds maintenance at all three properties. Total: $1,840.00, due November 20. Payment can be made through the usual method.

Thank you, Renee Castillo, Billing

## Email 3

**From:** Marisol Reyes marisol@larkspurproperty.example **Sent:** Thu, Nov 5, 3:05 PM **Subject:** Tuesday meeting

Hey Dana, can we push Tuesday's staff meeting to 11? I have a move-in walkthrough at 10 that I can't move. Same length is fine. Thanks!

## Email 4

**From:** Ivy Chen ivy.chen@example.org **Sent:** Thu, Nov 5, 4:48 PM **Subject:** Noise complaint, Unit 211

Hi, I'm in 211 at Maple Terrace. The unit next to me has been playing loud music past midnight almost every night this week. I've knocked once but nothing changed. I have work early. Can the office do something about this?

Ivy

## Email 5

**From:** Mark Delaney mdelaney@hillcountryins.example **Sent:** Fri, Nov 6, 8:30 AM **Subject:** Policy renewal review

Good morning Dana,

Your property insurance renews December 1. I'd like a 30-minute call to review coverage before then. Would Thursday, Nov 12 at 10:00 AM work? If not, I'm open anytime Friday the 13th.

Best, Mark Delaney, Hill Country Insurance

## Email 6

**From:** ReviewBoost deals@reviewboost.example **Sent:** Fri, Nov 6, 10:15 AM **Subject:** Get 5-star reviews FAST — 50% off this week only!

Property managers are using ReviewBoost to add dozens of 5-star reviews in days. Click here to claim 50% off before Sunday!

## Email 7

**From:** Paula Navarro, Code Compliance pnavarro@codecompliance.example **Sent:** Fri, Nov 6, 1:22 PM **Subject:** Confirmation needed: Inspection Nov 12, Willow Row

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Ms. Whitfield,

This confirms the routine inspection of Willow Row on Thursday, Nov 12, from 9:00 AM to 12:00 PM. We will need access to Units 301 through 306. Tenants must receive written notice at least 48 hours before the inspection.

Please reply to confirm by Tuesday, Nov 10, at 9:00 AM, or the inspection will be rescheduled.

Paula Navarro, Inspector

## Email 8

**From:** Fatima Noor fatima.noor@example.org **Sent:** Fri, Nov 6, 5:50 PM **Subject:** Rent this month

Hi Dana, my paycheck is delayed this month because of a payroll issue at work. Is it okay if I pay rent 5 days late? I've never been late before. Unit 305. Thank you so much.

## Email 9

**From:** Carlos Vega carlos.vega@example.com **Sent:** Sat, Nov 7, 7:18 AM **Subject:** bathroom ceiling

hi, theres a brown stain on my bathroom ceiling that wasnt there last week and its dripping a little now. i put a bucket under it. i called AquaFix from the fridge magnet and they said they will email you. unit 303 willow row

## Email 10

**From:** Jordan Ellis jordan.ellis@example.net **Sent:** Sat, Nov 7, 2:02 PM **Subject:** Viewing request — 1-bedroom at Willow Row

Hello, I saw your listing for the 1-bedroom at Willow Row and I'd love to see it. I'm free Wednesday at 2 PM or Tuesday at 3 PM. Please let me know what works.

Thanks, Jordan Ellis

## Email 11

**From:** Lone Star Landscaping Accounts accounts@lonestar-landscapinq.example **Sent:** Sat, Nov 7, 6:45 PM **Subject:** URGENT: Updated payment details for Invoice #1047

Dear Client,

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Our bank details have changed. Please send payment for Invoice #1047 to our new account using the attached form before Monday to avoid a late fee. Do not use the previous payment method.

Regards, Accounts Team

## Email 12

**From:** Olivia Scott olivia.scott@example.com **Sent:** Sun, Nov 8, 9:30 AM **Subject:** Water heater noise

Hi Dana, my water heater has been making a knocking sound since Friday and the floor next to it feels a little damp. Not sure if it's related to anything. I'm in 307, right above Carlos. Can someone check it?

Olivia

## Email 13

**From:** Rachel Stone rachel.stone@example.com **Sent:** Sun, Nov 8, 11:05 AM **Subject:** Lease renewal

Hi Dana! My lease in 213 ends in January and I'd love to renew for another year. Will the rent stay the same? I'd like to know soon so I can plan. Thanks!

Rachel

## Email 14

**From:** Bright Smile Dental reminders@brightsmile.example **Sent:** Sun, Nov 8, 4:20 PM **Subject:** Appointment reminder: Wed, Nov 11 at 2:00 PM

This is a reminder of your appointment on Wednesday, Nov 11, at 2:00 PM. Reply C to confirm or call us to reschedule.

## Email 15

**From:** AquaFix Plumbing dispatch@aquafix.example **Sent:** Mon, Nov 9, 6:40 AM **Subject:** Service request — Willow Row, Unit 303

Good morning,

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Your tenant Carlos Vega contacted us Saturday about a ceiling leak in Unit 303. We can come today, Monday at 1:00 PM, or Thursday at 10:00 AM. The diagnostic plus minor repair is estimated at $350. We'll quote before any larger work.

Please reply to confirm a time.

Dispatch, AquaFix Plumbing

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